

County Council Meeting, Dec. 16th, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jOuHOtFADOY
Publication Date	2025-12-17T02:59:11Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: December 16, 2025

Location: Delaware County, Indiana

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at 9:00 AM on December 16, 2025.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Swanger, Hughes, Mogul, Bookout, Sper [also referred to as Spicer/Speer in roll calls], Gance [also referred to as Kanz], and Whitehead [also referred to as Wyatt]. (Note: Name spellings reflect phonetic transcript variations during roll calls).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the Council President.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Nancy.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **00:01:10** November meeting minutes were presented with minor clean-up details by Marissa.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Financial Transfers & Appropriations

- **County General (Courts) 00:01:57**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of various positive and negative line-item adjustments within the courts budget resulting in a net-zero transfer.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **Public Defender Fund 00:03:41**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey (Public Defender's Office) / Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$10,000 from professional services to attorney fees to cover expenses from expensive trials, appeals, and contract attorney conflicts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **Statewide 911 00:05:46**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving \$3,000 from FICA to disability insurance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **Reassessment 00:06:25**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving \$100 from board members' appeal to longevity due to a line-item omission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **Adult User Fees 00:07:09**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving \$1,000 from health insurance to transportation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **High-Tech Crime Unit 00:07:51**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving \$225 from transportation to disability insurance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **Ball Brothers High-Tech Unit 00:08:26**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer of \$4,354.48 from conferences and training to software and equipment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Cumulative Bridge 00:09:00**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Highway Department staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$10,000 to cover bridge employee overtime through the end of the year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Motor Vehicle Highway 00:09:53**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Highway Department staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$20,000 from health insurance to overtime to cover highway employee call-out overtime based on seniority.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Board of Health 00:10:53**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer of \$1,200 from longevity to long-term disability.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Omnibus Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance Amendment 00:11:36**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve the financial transfers and amend the salary ordinance with like reductions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Backfilling Report 00:11:58**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to receive the backfilling report approved by roll call vote.
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Ordinances and Resolutions

- **00:12:23 Ordinance 2025-42: Hourly 911 and Sheriff's Deputy Longevity and Experience Pay**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Legal Counsel
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This ordinance extends the existing longevity and experience pay ranks and salary increases for hourly 911 operators and sheriff's deputies into 2026 without changes other than updating dates.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - First Reading: Introduced and approved for first reading by roll call vote.
 - Second Reading: Rules suspended to allow a second reading today (unanimous vote required and achieved).
 - Final Adoption: Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:16:23 Ordinance 2025-43: Pay Matrix / Salary Ordinance Extension**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Legal Counsel
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extends the point matrix pay structure for 2026 with no changes other than updating effective dates.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - First Reading: Introduced and approved by roll call vote.
 - Second Reading: Motion to allow second reading failed due to lack of unanimous consent (recorded with a dissenting "No" vote). Further reading/adoption deferred.
 - **00:18:17 Ordinance 2025-26: Second Reading & Adoption**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brought forward for second reading with an effective payroll date established for January 14, 2026.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
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Board Appointments & Committee Reports

- **Redevelopment Commission (Two 1-year terms): 00:20:18**
 - Nominees: Danielle Castle, Amber Green, Chester Kendrick, Scott Ratliff, and Rob Keyasling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Amber Green** and **Rob Keyasling** were appointed by roll call vote.
- **Fair Board (One 3-year term): 00:26:03**
 - Nominees: Amber Green and Bart Keyasling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Bart Keyasling** was appointed by roll call vote.
- **Daleville Economic Board (One 1-year term): 00:28:16**
 - Nominees: Brent Cheetum, Matt Porter, and Chester Kendrick.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Matt Porter** was appointed by roll call vote.
- **Tax Abatement Committee (Three 1-year terms): 00:30:21**
 - Nominees: Josh Perkins, Joe Bar, and Council Member Bookout (replacing Mr. Hughes).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Appointed by acclamation (unanimous voice vote).
- **Animal Care Services Board (One 3-year term): 00:32:07**
 - Nominees: Scott Ratliff, Matt Porter, and Austin Hamill.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Scott Ratliff** was appointed by roll call vote.
- **Alcohol Beverage Commission (One 1-year term): 00:33:50**
 - Nominees: Doug Hutchinson and Matt Porter.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Doug Hutchinson** was appointed by roll call vote.
- **Property Tax Board of Appeals (One 1-year term - Democratic seat): 00:34:45**
 - Nominee: Carrie Wiggler.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Carrie Wiggler** was appointed by roll call vote.
- **County Council Attorney (One 1-year term): 00:35:41**

- Nominee: Beasley & Gilkerson (with partner Aubrey Christrist designated as secondary attorney).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by acclamation.
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Committee & Department Reports

- **IT Committee Report (00:37:06 - Matt):**
 - Reported on a recent credential harvesting security incident involving a deceptive internal email. Users were strongly urged to change network passwords immediately and avoid clicking suspicious links.
 - Noted upcoming IT leadership changes as Jim Fluke's contract ends, with commissioners working to transition IT personnel to county or contract employee status.
 - Discussed an ongoing evaluation of moving email infrastructure from Microsoft to Google, which is temporarily paused until after the new year.
 - **Purdue Extension (00:43:54 - Justin Curley, Emily Kring, Amanda Bullian, Vicky Gasway):**
 - Announced leadership transitions: Justin Curley transferring to Wayne County; Amanda Bullian taking over as County Extension Director; Emily Kring joining as Ag Educator; and Vicky Gasway introduced as the 4-H Educator.
 - Highlighted that Amanda Bullian recently received a national Family and Consumer Science award.
 - Noted robust 4-H enrollment (over 300 youth and 100 adult volunteers) emphasizing programs are open to all youth, not just farm families.
 - **Auditor's Office (00:45:24 - Tanya Dunmore):**
 - Introduced Chelsea Welsh, promoted from payroll deputy to head bookkeeper.
 - **Court Administrator Update (00:45:58 - Emily Anderson):**
 - Provided an update on CASA grants, noting potential federal VOCA grant reductions at the state level (up to 40%) which may impact staffing levels by July. Noted a current waitlist of 170 children and the hiring of a new volunteer coordinator starting in January.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the public comment period.*
00:48:38
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Board Announcements:** Council members exchanged holiday wishes (Merry Christmas and Happy New Year) and thanked highway department crews for their work during recent winter weather ("Snow Medon 2025").
 - **Next Meeting Date:** Scheduled for January 27, 2026.
 - **Adjournment:** 00:49:28 Official motion to adjourn passed by roll call vote.
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